Light as a Feather

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by Yolowritter

Summary

Nathalie knew she didn't deserve the kindness Emilie and Gabriel had shown her in the last two years. Yet she'd rewarded it by taking their clearly platonic affections and twisting them inside the privacy of her own mind. How dare she objectify them and feel such lust when her friends were nice enough to teach her unconditional love?

On their first major gala celebration for the *Gabriel* brand, Nathalie can't get her attraction to them out of her mind. Emilie and Gabriel are about to show her how loved she truly is.

Written for Sangreste Week 2026 Day 6: Gala

Notes

Wholesome Sangreste with horny Nathalie? In my emotionally complicated polycule? More likely than you think! But yeah, we're celebrating the fandom's most codependant polycule with this fic! Happy Sangreste Week to everyone! And of course, Tomoe is the real MVP here! You'll see!

Or: Come watch Nathalie Sancoeur be a guilt-ridden, oblivious idiot about two people who very clearly love her. Also, Gabriel and Emilie are being nice for once! Because it's my Sangreste and you can't force me to them more depressed!

See the end of the work for more notes

Aggressively dripping through her panties at their first real gala wasn't what Nathalie Sancoeur would consider professional decorum. Neither was being possessed of a brain so engorged on fantasies which had *no* business seeing the light of day that she failed to pay attention to anything going on around her. If she wasn't keeping notes and looking sternly professional on autopilot, her job and dignity would both have kissed her a bitter goodbye half an hour ago. Alas, that was the price she needed to pay when working for Gabriel and Emilie Agreste. Even when it came at the cost of *desperately* needing a dry pair of undergarments and preferably a hole to go crawl in so she could die of embarrassment in relative peace.

The world-infamous Style Queen herself was currently blabbering on about artistic integrity and her importance to the ecological balance of the Parisian fashion district, but Audrey had never claimed humility as a personal strength. For the life of her, Nathalie couldn't keep her eyes and ears on the woman long enough to comprehend what she was even talking about; color composition maybe? Certainly something sounding like her *unique* brand of praise, for Gabriel looked delightedly impressed with himself as she offered the tiniest curl of the lip.

Audrey was in a chipper mood this evening, given that she deigned to acknowledge her existence with a curt nod and slight tip of her sunglasses. Neither she nor Gabriel commented on the fact she was wearing those indoors; whether or not she was sensitive to the overhead lighting or simply nursing the worst hangover since that time Nathalie accidentally wound up married to Emilie's sister in Las Vegas was none of their business. Best fifteen drunken minutes of her life, not that she remembered anything but a total blur. Miss Amelie hadn't *exactly* forgiven her for that yet, but she had more imminent woman problems to concern herself with. Namely, the living goddess which descended from the heavens themselves to bless Nathalie's eyes with a visage no siren could even hope to compete with.

Those were Gabriel's direct throughs; she extracted them from the gentle look in his eyes and shared in their appreciative nature unabashedly, though he thankfully didn't seem to notice her staring longingly at his beloved wife. Her wayward fantasies deserved no less than the tightest of leashes with how Nathalie felt her control slip when she around either of them too long. What began as entirely professional admiration had nowadays devolved into obsessive behavior that was intolerable in the workplace; frankly, she ought to spare their perfect marriage from her heart's nonsensical whims and put in her two weeks' notice come morning. She would rather keel over than do so, hence the responsible part of her brain having long since drowned in a river of her own delusions.

The gentle glances and soft touches those two frequently offered were just so she could acclimate to something resembling a healthy environment. Nathalie could distinctly remember being a *difficult* child for her father to raise. Her interests in the sublime and dishearteningly niche media from a young age meant that the only constant relating to friends in her early years was their complete and total absence from her reality. Given that she was also…*sheltered*—for lack of a term which didn't make her violently convulse—it was best to never spare her father the time of day. She was *out* now; the people who cared about her may have counted to a measly two, but Nathalie Sancoeur knew she was deeply loved. They both showed it constantly; Gabriel with small smiles and approving glances that almost looked

like he was eternally grateful for her assistance, while Emilie leaned further into physical comfort.

It was downright despicable for her to be interpreting such gestures of profound kindness in ways which caused the current state of her undergarments. Nathalie felt a churning in her stomach from daring to disrespect them like this, to objectify her *married* friends and not hold herself up to a proper personal standard. They adored each other so blatantly that their love was all anybody ever talked about when not discussing the unprecedented success of their brand. Gabriel and Emilie Agreste were Paris'—perhaps even all of France's—perfect sweethearts; their assistant's misplaced emotions shouldn't disturb that happiness.

Whenever they hugged or attempted to coax her into bypassing those professional barriers even for a moment, she immediately felt guilty for accepting without a second thought. Nathalie Sancoeur understood perfectly well how to be friendly; it was simply impossible for her to remain so with them. No matter how ruthlessly she suppressed her thoughts, they always circled back to unwanted questions. Would Gabriel ever look her in the eye with that same gentleness as when holding his wife? Might Emilie hold her tighter than necessary when they were alone? What could possibly occur if they all let themselves forget propriety and allowed their hands to wander for a scant couple of moments?

She truly was a creature whose vileness rarely reared its ugly head to face the world. *Why?* Why couldn't her heart just accept the perfectly platonic affections it was given and reciprocate in turn? Nathalie felt disgusted with herself every time her gaze wandered to Emilie's lips, to Gabriel's calloused hand as it curled tightly around a stylus or to how their eyes narrowed in concentration when there was a new passion project to devote themselves to within the Atelier. Only after many years of fighting tooth and nail for their love did her best friends finally acquire the fairytale ending they'd desperately wished for once upon a time, yet here Nathalie was about to ruin it all with *complications*. All because she carnally desired them so much that her upper thighs were soaked during what should be *their* celebration.

A sharp click of Audrey's heels ripped out a heartstring and swiftly returned her to reality. Gabriel was looking at her now, noting the subtle hints of sweat on her brow; even the most imperceptible of cracks in her professional demeanor were as plainly visible to him as torn stitching on fabric. He didn't verbally acknowledge it amidst the crowd of socialites they were allegedly delighted to invite to this gala, but she spared him a softness rarely seen in her eyes to keep his questions at bay a moment longer. Gabriel stilled at that, taking a shaky breath and hiding a small smile by turning the other way. Emilie's voice still rang in both their ears as she continued turning the stage intended for an announcer into her personal recital; she twirled and danced around herself like each motion was in accordance with the very laws of nature. As if anyone *other* than her under the spotlight would be an affront to all of creation and shatter a fundamental component of their reality. Nobody could fully take their eyes off her as she cradled the microphone like a long-lost lover. Nathalie Sancoeur refused to admit she suddenly felt immensely jealous of an inanimate object.

It was distinctly uncomfortable to walk around in such dampness, yet she persevered without complaint. If Gabriel was to ever *imagine* her predicament she would surely obliterate all the gracious goodwill they'd shown her by allowed Nathalie into their loving family. Tomoe Tsurugi was the only notable person amongst a sea of shallow congratulations and deep

resentment bubbling under the surface. Those envious of true talent and honest success still came to ostensibly reward the Agrestes with firm handshakes or sweet smiles. In truth, it was all to make connections and perhaps a dreadfully unsubtle implication of wanting to enter some backroom deal. In her humble opinion, she had more than enough illicit practices while still under her father's boot to tolerate such ambitions.

Regrettably, she didn't manage to pay much attention to the woman as she conversed with Gabriel and even expressed that their unprecedented success was a genuine achievement to take pride in. Nathalie quite admired Tomoe, if only from afar. She'd established herself as the no-nonsense type of businesswoman capable of burning one's career to the ground with merely a word, yet never abused the authority granted by her position in the various industries she had a hand in to intentionally cause problems for people who didn't rightly deserve them. At the very least in the sense of not being vindicative about it; becoming her competitor was a death sentence certain idiots were entirely liable for on their lonesome. It was easy for her to be blunt; networking and pleasantries annoyed everyone, but Tomoe was the only person Nathalie could claim a genuine acquaintance to who could just say so aloud without repercussion.

They'd spent several consecutive minutes discussing quietly at events as Emilie and Gabriel stole the show from whoever was actually supposed to be hosting in the past. Despite the occasional exchange and shared perceptive barb at the expense of the nearest walking sack of incompetence, they weren't exactly friends. Business associates who could handle being in the same room without mutually envisioning homicide was probably an accomplishment in and of itself. The soft-spoken conversation between Gabriel and Tomoe slowly faded from the back of her mind completely as Emilie's voice picked up for the chorus of her song, locking him in a trance as he became blind and deaf to anything which wasn't his wife's bedazzling performance. Nathalie was only spared from the same fate by the acute reminder that her undergarments were in *no* state for her to be indulging in certain kinds of fantasy.

"Do forgive my insolence, but I cannot understand how Gabriel is ignoring the smell," Tomoe whispered in her ear with a small bow meant only for propriety in a public setting, assuredly not for any high regard she held Nathalie in. "You reek of desperation and it is distracting. As I was telling your master, our business relationship can only continue if the Agreste brand is committed to progress above all. Do not stagnate because of your base instincts. I did not come to tolerate conversation with a hound." The stern tone left her reeling; she went crimson as she looked down at herself. There wasn't a visible stain on her pants yet, so surely the words were a mere metaphor?

By the time she composed herself enough to turn and ask, Tomoe had already walked away to instead discuss with a young-looking businessman. The boy was barely old enough to be here and clearly representing someone else's interests, trembling in his boots at the mere sight of her. She conducted herself swiftly and vanished in the crowd before Gabriel even blinked himself out of his Emilie-induced stupor. Reality hit him with the utmost displeasure, since it wasn't currently allowing him for him to praise and worship his angel like she deserved.

"Miss Tsurugi had urgent matters to attend to," Nathalie offered by way of explanation, if only to assure him that the problem was irrelevant to their professional relationship. He narrowed his eyes at her *again*, clearly concerned by the stiff sound of her voice. "I'm *fine*,

sir. Merely a personal matter that's on my mind," she said swiftly, earning herself a look more befitting on the face of his wife.

"So the spreadsheets finally left space for something else?" Gabriel had the gall to tease her with quick wit when she was already in such a ruffled state. He went as far as gently smiling at Nathalie and interlocking their hands as he spared a glance to the stage. Emilie caught his gaze immediately; her dancing routine *hitched* so imperceptibly that she thought her eyes were deceiving her. "In that case, we better make sure you aren't falling ill. Come, time to head home," he suggested ever so softly, yet Nathalie couldn't find the strength to broker a compromise.

"I am perfectly capable of fulfilling my duties for the remainder of the event. There is no need to miss out on a potential opportunity," she insisted instead, since falling into the trap of arguing toward some imaginary middle ground would only result in Gabriel moving heaven and earth to buy time for Emilie to meet up with them and systematically dismantle her negotiations with a single pleading look. Nathalie never *did* figure out how to refuse such a sweet and caring smile.

"Your health is far more important to both of us than playing nice with socialites," he told her gently, subtly gesturing to her lower half. Her legs were ever so slightly bend and quivering by the millimeter; Nathalie's breath was just shy of hitching as she forcefully tore her gaze from the angel finishing up a dance onstage. How exactly could she even think of telling him that the stance was merely so her drenched panties wouldn't cause a stain on her legwear? Who in their right mind wouldn't fire her and immediately eject Nathalie from their lives if she brazenly confessed to objectifying them both so brazenly? To *wanting them* in ways she had no business fantasizing about?

Emilie excused herself from the stage with a brazen announcement that the three of them were taking their leave for tonight, which fell on her deaf ears as panic swelled up in her chest. For all the things people may call her, Nathalie Sancoeur was no fool. Tomoe had *noticed*. Some part of her professional decorum was insufficient to fully conceal these emotions she wasn't *meant* to have. Gabriel and Emilie were the most brilliant people she's ever known. A single glance away from prying eyes and they too would understand in a fraction of a second. Nathalie stilled completely as they gently guided her to the exit, feeling her joints go stiff as a statue's. It…it would go precisely as she'd feared. They'd been kind enough to consider her a friend and she owed it to them both to at least be honest. She would own up to her transgressions and face the consequences they felt she deserved for accepting their affections under pretenses mismatched with the intention of those acts.

They were driven back to the manor in complete silence. Rather, Nathalie's mind was buzzing with so many possibilities as she desperately hunted down the right words for once they arrived that she was utterly deaf to their concern. It wasn't *fair* to them for her to be acting like this, tonight especially. Tonight, when the *Gabriel* brand was celebrating the unprecedented success of its first show. They should've stayed at the party to share drinks and smiles with people who appreciated their talents, not ran off with a woman holding desperately onto carnal desires like a dog dug its teeth into a piece of juicy steak. All Nathalie could do to keep appearances through the terror of rejection was default to her impassive, polite expression.

As if anything about this was normal and she'd wake up tomorrow in precisely the same circumstances as always; to Emilie making them a hearty round of breakfast—the only time she wasn't at risk of burning down the kitchen—and Gabriel wordlessly passing her a fresh pot of coffee, not even bothering with the mug. Emilie would always laugh under her breath and fetch one anyway, jesting about how even though the taste of Nathalie in their morning beverages would apparently be *welcome*, it was unhealthy to pour so much caffeine down her throat just because she wasn't a morning person. Gabriel never failed to tease her for being a maniac whose eyes snapped open at the crack of dawn without fail, but it only ever earned him a gasp of mock offense and a kiss to the cheek.

Her heart always fluttered ever so warmly at the scene; the constant which played out entirely unchanged lest reality collapse on itself from the lack of domestic mundanity. The design team over at the office were usually losing their minds around that time of day, potentially setting something aflame over failing to pick out a color palette for the next piece Gabriel had envisioned in his mad artistic genius. Nathalie felt the corners of her mouth crinkle upward at that; she smoothed her expression immediately after, but wasn't quick enough to avoid a soft look from Emilie, who took the barest shred if a positive reaction from her as permission to ever so gently place a hand on her knee, asking if she was alright.

Fraudulence was a trait so inherently human that Nathalie never got it quite right. Not with *them*, who'd taught her everything she knew on how to be alive. She squirmed under the touch, visibly enough for Gabriel to take action and detach his wife's palm despite Emilie's silent protests. They were both so *worried* over nothing at all; Nathalie had brought this on herself. Her miserable state was entirely a consequence of her own cowardice. If only she'd been brave enough to do the right thing months ago, they could've parted on amicable terms. Perhaps it would even have been somewhat sweet amidst the innate bitterness of heartbreak. Instead she acted the part of a leech, draining every scrap of affection out of their relationship in a matter misaligned with the platonic friendship they so kindly included her in.

Nathalie was barely a rung above all the mindless vermin who cheered and awed whence Emilie twirled and spun onstage to show off Gabriel's newest designs, so accustomed to a delusion of their personal making that they had the *gall* to believe such a woman would ever grant them a singular moment of her time. Emilie's adorations toward her fans were mere amusement; she enjoyed teasing and getting a rise out of the crowd. How many times had she joked with them about one funny reaction or another over dinner? And here was her alleged best friend, utterly heedless of the loving marriage she'd finely crafted through blood and sweat.

She shamelessly lusted after both Emilie and her husband; she'd jerked her leg away lest either of them notice the dampness which had begun to seep into her pants since sitting down inside the car. Nathalie silently burned with shame as the wheels finally ground to a halt against the asphalt, unable to muster so much as the barest hint of affirmation or excuse. The ever-useful insistence that she was *fine* caught in her throat; lying to them now would feel like racking herself over flaming coals. The moment Emilie tried to interlock their hands again, Nathalie pulled away, crossing both over her chest and mindlessly striding inside the manor without looking up from the ground. Her best friends made twin noises of concern, dripping their worries in deaf ears.

It was Gabriel who caught her wrist before she could flee upstairs. Not harshly like her father; he was comically gentle in comparison, but didn't treat her as if her bones were made of glass. Emilie refused to look her in the eye after she averted her gaze one time too many, so it was up to him to keep the peace. Nathalie tugged her arm away from his grip, yet he remained firm against the simmering guilt in her veins. She went as far as glaring angrily into Gabriel's soul. Rather predictably, it had no effect. Only he could ever match her in sheer stubbornness. She persisted, her foot planted firmly on the first stair and body half-turned to seek safety in her quarters, away from this conflict.

"I know you don't want to talk," he acknowledged softly, finally letting go once it was clear she wouldn't immediately run off. "*You* know we're worried and only want to help. Tell us how," Gabriel suggested—not ordered, as she'd once perceived his instructions back when she couldn't tell the difference between a gesture of support and a mental shackle—caressing her fingertips with his thumb. Emilie raised her head too, at least long enough to agree and offer a meager smile to conceal her upset.

"The matter is entirely inconsequential," Nathalie deflected without a second thought. She needed *time* to decode the situation in its entirety. How was she meant to formulate a proper response without understanding what they were feeling? How could she *leave* without knowing the way to say goodbye? "I simply…have a lot on my mind. There is something we should discuss, yes, but not tonight."

Emilie had the indecency to raise an eyebrow, entirely unimpressed. "So you've been shaking like a leaf the whole ride home for no reason at all? Even my wedding jitters weren't that bad, Nathalie," she growled accusatorily despite wanting to stay gentle. It wasn't in her nature to accept excuses which turned pain into a more palatable meal. Had enough of those from her sister to last a lifetime, though Nathalie was sworn never to reveal so to another living soul. "If there's something you want to say, we're all ears."

It was as much invitation to air her worries as to a court hearing, with herself as the defendant and no argument with which to skirt by the inevitable consequences of greed. Nathalie *knew* she wanted far too much; desired the sorts of love Gabriel and Emilie had proven time and time again extended exclusively between them. Yet she remained unrepentant in her wanton lusts; her gaze flickered to Gabriel's hands as he worked the threads and pencil, or Emilie's lips and flowing form as she modeled onstage. In the end, her friends knew best. Right as always; the undisputed fact of life which had thwarted monsters far greater than the indecent thoughts miring her mind.

She refused to acknowledge her personal agency in the matter as they all headed upstairs together. Nathalie simply felt more at ease while believing that a guilty plea and banishment were firmly entrenched in her immediate future. It took less mental effort to prepare for the devastation than dare hope they would somehow forgive her for mangling their affections into shapes they weren't built to take. Where Emilie gently held her hand to comfort and offer warmth, Gabriel allowed her to lean on his shoulder just enough for a tiny sob to escape Nathalie. Only he heard, looking her in the eye yet saying nothing. Yet another unearned kindness that was devoured gleefully by her traitorous heart.

By the time they made it upstairs, Emilie had already taken the initiative and the hard left toward her and Gabriel's bedroom. Ostensibly because there was more space or felt more private a location compared to the mess of her disorganized study, but that didn't help Nathalie combat her internal dread. They gently sat down on either side of her once she took her place atop the bed, knowing that the closeness was a source of comfort when she was upset. About her father, her overwhelming responsibilities, or even a bad day at the office, *yes*. But being squished between two friends she was about to lose and with a sword of Damocles handing low over her head, Nathalie couldn't have felt any *less* easy if she genuinely tried.

Nobody spoke for several moments while she took deep breaths, attempting fruitlessly to calm her racing heart. There was no reason for her to be acting irrationally; she'd already *decided* to come clean tonight before they even left the gala. Honesty was the least Nathalie owed in light of their kindness during the past years. She felt her body jostle wildly at the understanding that what they had between them was about to be broken beyond repair…but attempted to formulate words despite that. Being so close, Emilie had noticed the small stain on her pants now. She'd never *demand* an answer, though the curiosity was evident in her eyes.

It was best to simply rip out her heart in one quick moment to lessen the pain.

"I'm in love with you both!" Nathalie heard the words echo in the amphitheater that was their bedchamber, yet didn't feel her lips move to pronounce them. She sat frozen in place, hastily attempting to ice her heart as their expressions twitched upon processing her admission. "I… please forgive me. I'm a horrible friend. You're so *happy* together, but I just can't help myself!" she pleaded desperately, her sight blurring from unshed tears as they finally connected the dots on all those moments of strange yet plausibly deniable behavior.

Gabriel didn't dare to break the silence which befell them, not before sharing a slow look of realization with his wife. Emilie's gaze fell squarely on the stain; she slowly extended a finger to tap the damp fabric of her pants as if to confirm what it really was. Nathalie had given into her base desires so deeply that neither her overclothes nor undergarments had any time to dry during the ride home; it wasn't like she got the opportunity to change before they sat her down to talk. By now, surely even their infinite patience was being tested with the proof that she was lesser than even a wild animal. One who saw them at their happiest and still *wanted*, who dared objectify the only people who'd ever shown her true friendship for the sake of her lust. How could they stand to breathe the air as her still, Nathalie failed to comprehend.

"Well of course you are!" Emilie said with a sunny smile, sighing in *relief* like this entire situation was no more than a silly little joke. She blinked up at her, waiting for the rest of the tease or some indication that her friend was merely fishing for levity…but it didn't come. "Is that seriously all you wanted to say? *Nat*, we've been flirting with you for well over a year! I'd be concerned if you *hadn't* caught feelings by now!" Emilie exclaimed softly, as if she'd nearly taken offense at the implication of her seduction skills being anything less than impeccable.

Nathalie blinked, took off her glasses to rub her eyes, put them on again…and promptly stared at them like they'd grown several additional heads out of their necks.

"What Em means to say is that we underestimated how dense you are. And yes, it's been obvious. We were just waiting for you to come to us first. It didn't feel right to push," said Gabriel, ever-considerate of other people's feelings after learning to be 'less of a prick'—in Emilie's exact wording—than when he still dressed himself in gaudy leather jackets and went on joyrides for fun. He stared at her for a moment, seeing that her brain was currently incapable of comprehending his meaning. "*Yes*, we love you back." Gabriel sighed in exasperation, gently squeezing her shoulder to make sure she didn't suddenly topple over from the shock.

"…*what?*" The question slipped out before she could stop herself from speaking. Preferably also from breathing any further, because Nathalie Sancoeur suddenly felt like a genuine contender for densest object in the universe, perhaps even capable of dethroning the black hole. At least they weren't looking at her judgmentally, though Emilie was visibly struggling to keep her composure.

She leaned into her without hesitation, gazing longingly into Nathalie's eyes as if she'd been holding herself back every time they were close before. A moment passed, silent except for her friend's gentle breathing caressing her cheek with a warm touch. It was almost enough to fool her nerves into relaxing; Nathalie dared to attempt processing that the romantic connotations she'd considered wild fantasies were in fact entirely accurate. There laid the trap Emilie had so expertly set. Her best friend's gaze flickered downward almost innocently, as if her suspicions regarding the stain on Nathalie's pants were entirely forgotten. She extended a finger to tap against the fabric again before bringing it to her face and taking a small sniff.

"*Aww*…are we the reason you're like this, Nat? Did you get *that* excited watching me dance?" she teased shamelessly, grinning from ear to ear and barely bothered to stifle a giggle. "I *know* how much you enjoy it when Gabriel is fretting over you. He's just the sweetest! So…am I right, or am I *right*?" the temptress spoke again, pressing into her side and preening as she watched Nathalie turn several shades redder in the blink of an eye. Of course, Emilie had correctly perceived her love confession as invitation to engage in salacious flirting. But she didn't have to look so smug at making her swallow her own tongue in the process!

"It—it was still wrong of me to formulate such thoughts on you!" Nathalie stammered nervously, enough for Gabriel to gently nudge his wife in her defense. The goddess in the room reluctantly gave some of her space back, wanting her able to speak with at least *some* coherence. "I…I'm terribly ashamed of myself. I objectified and lusted after you!" she confessed with bated breath, feeling the ever-present pressure of guilt slowly lift once the words were finally out of her mouth. Wasn't it entirely different to adore them romantically and permit herself all manner of bedroom fantasies, even if Emilie clearly took it as a compliment?

"It's not like we didn't suspect," Gabriel pointed out most helpfully, if one was to consider an attempt on her sanity productive. "Really, this is all one big misunderstanding. We shouldn't

have let it go on as long as it did anyway," he said with a small frown, glancing over to his wife to finally concede a point which had been hers from the very beginning of their debate. Nathalie could logically understand that they discussed how exactly to *handle* her, but the part of her brain which had frozen solid from the shock of reciprocation evidently still held enough sway to suppress her squeal of excitement.

"You should've come to us about it, Nat. Even without anything *formal*, we'd have been more than happy to help you take care of those…inconvenient dreams." Emilie was so blatant in her suggestiveness that Nathalie found it impossible to believe she hadn't personally fantasized about said circumstances. Of herself, hesitantly knocking on their bedroom door in the dead of night, legs quivering and with heaving breath. Desperate, *longing* for any relief she could find. Emilie had surely envisioned herself playing the part of supportive friend and assisting her through those restless moments. "We still are, given your little problem down there…"

Nathalie paled, following her gaze to see that her pants were now properly soaked near the crotch. A spike of shame bolted her to the bed as she tried to apologize, but her throat felt so dry that she barely managed a small wheeze. Neither of them seemed offended at the reaction, nor the possibility of staining their bedsheets. She managed to inhale without choking on air as Gabriel gently placed a hand on her shoulder. Nathalie's racing mind grinded to a halt at the touch. She felt like someone had dragged her kicking and screaming atop a stage with every light pointed directly at her flummoxed expression. That she would ever receive this kind of attention from them was inconceivable; she failed to prepare for the chance and was now paying the price.

Without saying a word, she carefully lowered her pants down to her knees, stretching her legs to fully push them off. Her panties were as drenched as she'd felt on the ride home; Nathalie refrained from attempting to gauge their reactions to the sight as she gingerly tugged on them, discarding her undergarments. She took a deep breath in a vain attempt at maintaining composure; Gabriel and Emilie didn't touch her despite glancing down with a healthy amount of interest. Nathalie *believed them* when she was told they reciprocated her feelings. Wanted so badly to be extended the same instinctual affection they reserved for their spouse that had her faculties not been solely occupied with keeping her sane, she would've immediately begun to fret over offering them something in lieu of a wedding band for being included. And yet, they didn't immediately jump into acts of lust.

It was terribly unlike her to feel nervous about sitting between them. Bottomless or not, Nathalie Sancoeur had faced significantly more intimate situations and survived nearly unscathed. Gabriel's track record for inexplicably falling asleep on her during overtime work was so vast that they'd given up counting. Emilie was in the eternally-flustering habit of cuddling her assistant like a stuffed animal before inhaling her morning tea. They'd all collapsed atop each other on this very bed dozens of times, taking comfort in the shared warmth of body heat until blissful unconsciousness rescued them from the exhaustion of newfangled infamy all across the world. The concept of physical closeness was a milestone *long* surpassed, to the point where even the blasé and uncaring Audrey Bourgeois had raised an eyebrow regarding said intimacy.

Nathalie didn't comprehend why she was suddenly having a problem with letting them ravish her until nobody could so much as lift the blankets over their threesome. Now that she had affirmation from them both, nothing was physically preventing her from jumping Emilie's bones or committing indecencies with Gabriel in broad daylight. Preferably both, without having to wait till dawn to experience it. She hesitated to touch them anyway, unable to decide where she was allowed to place her hands. Nathalie found herself being gently nudged further up the mattress by them both: one on each side as she was comfortably settled against the pillows like she belonged on their bed as Emilie gently nudged her there.

It was clear to them that for all her desperation and desire, she still needed time to understand that she was loved before rushing into what they wanted to spend the night doing. Gabriel produced his handkerchief and began to carefully clean her thighs as his wife's fingers ran through her hair, lowering to tap against her glasses and set them on the nightstand. Emilie was first to undress herself completely—for the sake of comfort—and lay down next to her, allowing Nathalie to feel the warm breath brushing against her cheek. Gabriel followed her lead but not before assisting with removing her blouse, undoing each button with precision and reaching to unclasp her bra so she wouldn't need to move much.

They laid together for a moment without any wandering hands; it took exceptional self-restraint from her employers, almost as much as from Nathalie herself. The sensation of their bodies enveloping her like a protective cocoon of adoration sent a warm flush to her cheeks. Her breath hitched for but a moment, yet it was enough for Emilie to peck her on the jaw as a sweet comfort. Gabriel had enough mind left to wrangle the blanket out from underneath them and pull it up as cover. Nathalie took a sharp breath as the blush on her cheeks began to fade. Despite her fantasies being pushed to the wayside tonight, she didn't find herself minding one bit. They hadn't kicked her out or gotten mad at all. Emilie and Gabriel *loved her back*.

She struggled to wrap her mind around such an impossible notion, but being embraced as if every inch of her body was a precious treasure left her unable to deny it. The sensations of security which had allured her to their affections suddenly mellowed into a softer feeling. Nathalie was *content*, of all things, simply from laying with them on a comfortable bed. Because they understood. Because she'd managed to rip the words out of her chest without being rejected. The guilty pleasures which had weighed her down into the depths of depravity dissipated like wisps to the summer breeze…and Nathalie felt light as feather as she remembered to wrap her arms around them both, pulling them closer.

End Notes

So...how was that opening line, you guys? Did it get the point across? And once again, Tomoe Tsurugi moves the plot forward! Who knows how long it would've taken Nathalie to confess without that push? In all seriousness, I love Sangreste and it was fun to make something for this event! If it felt like I was cutting off a little at the end there...this was initially supposed to include a threesome and be rated E, but Nathalie ghostwrote too many thoughts and 6k seemed like enough!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!